

Worldwide PC shipments show flat growth in Q3 of 2018

Worldwide PC shipments totalled 67.2 million units in the third quarter of 2018—a 0.1 per cent increase from the third quarter of 2017, according to a report by Gartner Inc. The global market has shown modest stability for two consecutive quarters.

Europe, the Middle East and Africa (EMEA), Asia-Pacific and Japan experienced growth in the third quarter of 2018, while the US and Latin America declined. Latin America showed the steepest decline of 8.5

per cent after showing some stabilisation in 2018. However, these results are in line with Gartner's expectations in view of CPU supply constraints for the rest of the year.

Mikako Kitagawa, principal analyst at Gartner, said, "The PC market continued to be driven by steady corporate PC demand, which was, in turn, driven by Windows 10 PC hardware upgrades. We expect Windows 10 upgrade cycle to continue through 2020, at which point the upgrade demand will diminish."

India's solar market leaders see healthy competition during first half of 2018

As per the recent report 'India Solar Market Leaderboard 1H 2018' by Mercom Communications India, during the first half of calendar year 2018, India installed 4.9GW of solar power across the country, consolidating its position as the second largest solar market in the world behind China in the first half of 2018, and the fifth largest solar market in the world for total cumulative installations. The Indian solar market continues to be one of the most important in the world.

According to the report, the top 10 large-scale developers accounted for 55 per cent market share, with all others making up the remaining 45 per cent. There were also approximately 300 utility-scale project developers in the country with projects of at least 5MW or more in operation.

Adani remained the largest project developer in terms of total cumulative installations, as well as the top installer in terms of capacity installed through the end of first half of 2018.

Government increases import duty on telecom equipment to 20 per cent

As part of its measures to reduce the current account deficit (CAD) and preventing further weakening of the Rupee, the government of India has increased the basic customs duty on 17 items, including various telecom equipment, as per a notification released by Ministry of Finance.

The government has raised

import duty on various telecom equipment and levied basic customs duty on printed circuit boards, as India is looking to check imports of non-essential items, to address the country's CAD and boost Make in India programme.

In another notification, the Ministry also curbed the use of imported electronic intermediate goods that are

On The Move

Cognizant board elects Michael Patsalos-Fox as chairman

Cognizant has announced that its board of directors has elected board member Michael Patsalos-Fox as its chairman. He succeeds John E. Klein, who served as chairman for nearly 15 years, and will remain a board member. Patsalos-Fox was elected to Cognizant board in July 2012, and serves on finance, management development and compensation, and nominating, governance and public affairs committees.

Facebook appoints Ajit Mohan as India head

Technology giant Facebook has appointed Ajit Mohan as managing director and vice president of the social networking site's India operations. Mohan, who was previously chief executive officer of video streaming platform Hotstar, will join Facebook early next year. He will be responsible for aligning teams and driving Facebook's overall strategy in India.

Komal Lahiri appointed grievance officer for WhatsApp in India

WhatsApp has appointed Komal Lahiri as its grievance officer for India amid growing concerns over the spread of fake news on social media platforms. The company also laid out processes to report concerns and flag objectionable content and fake news.

Wipro healthcare division head Jeffrey Jalil quits

Wipro's healthcare and life sciences division head Jeffrey Heenan Jalil has resigned. The company has appointed an interim head to oversee the US\$ 1.1 billion healthcare business division even as the firm looks for a successor to Jalil.

majorly used in the manufacturing of telecom equipment, in the domestic manufacturing of the latter. In addition, several other telecom products that were under the zero duty would now be imposed with a customs duty of 10 per cent.